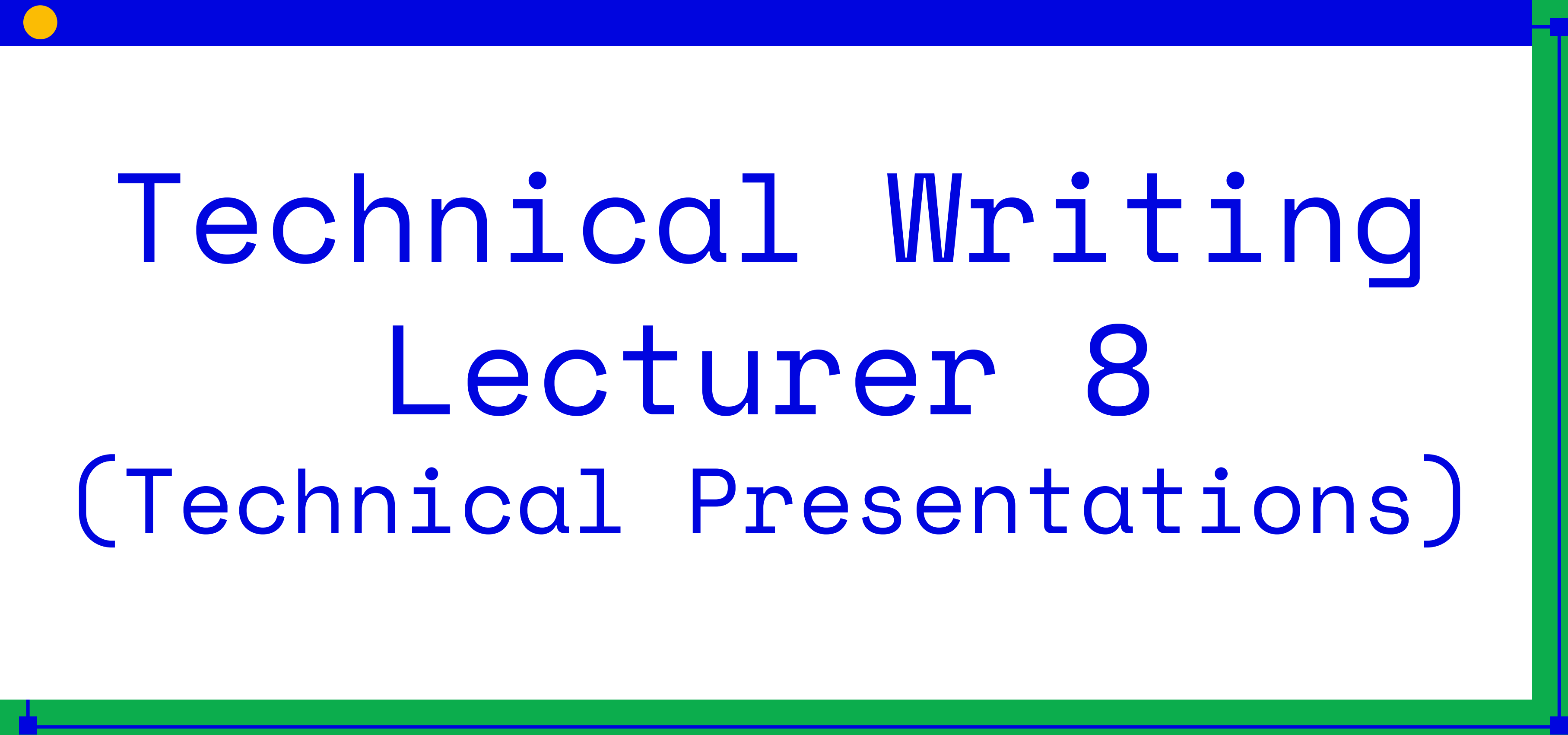




# Technical Writing

## Lecturer 8

(Technical Presentations)

# Agenda: Mastering Technical Presentations

1. Building Confidence
2. Developing Skills
3. Presenting as a Team
4. Questions



# Building Confidence



# Building Confidence as a Presenter

- Acknowledge the Challenge
  - "Public Speaking Anxiety" is one of the most common fears worldwide
  - Example: the way your voice shakes when explaining a line of code to a professor
  - You are not alone in this feeling; it is a natural human reaction
- Recognize the Costs of Staying Shy and Benefits of Speaking Up
- Commit to Learning
  - Public speaking is a "soft skill"
  - You are not born knowing how to do it; you improve through study and repetition
  - You develop your voice by studying the techniques used by successful presenters

# The Costs of Staying Shy



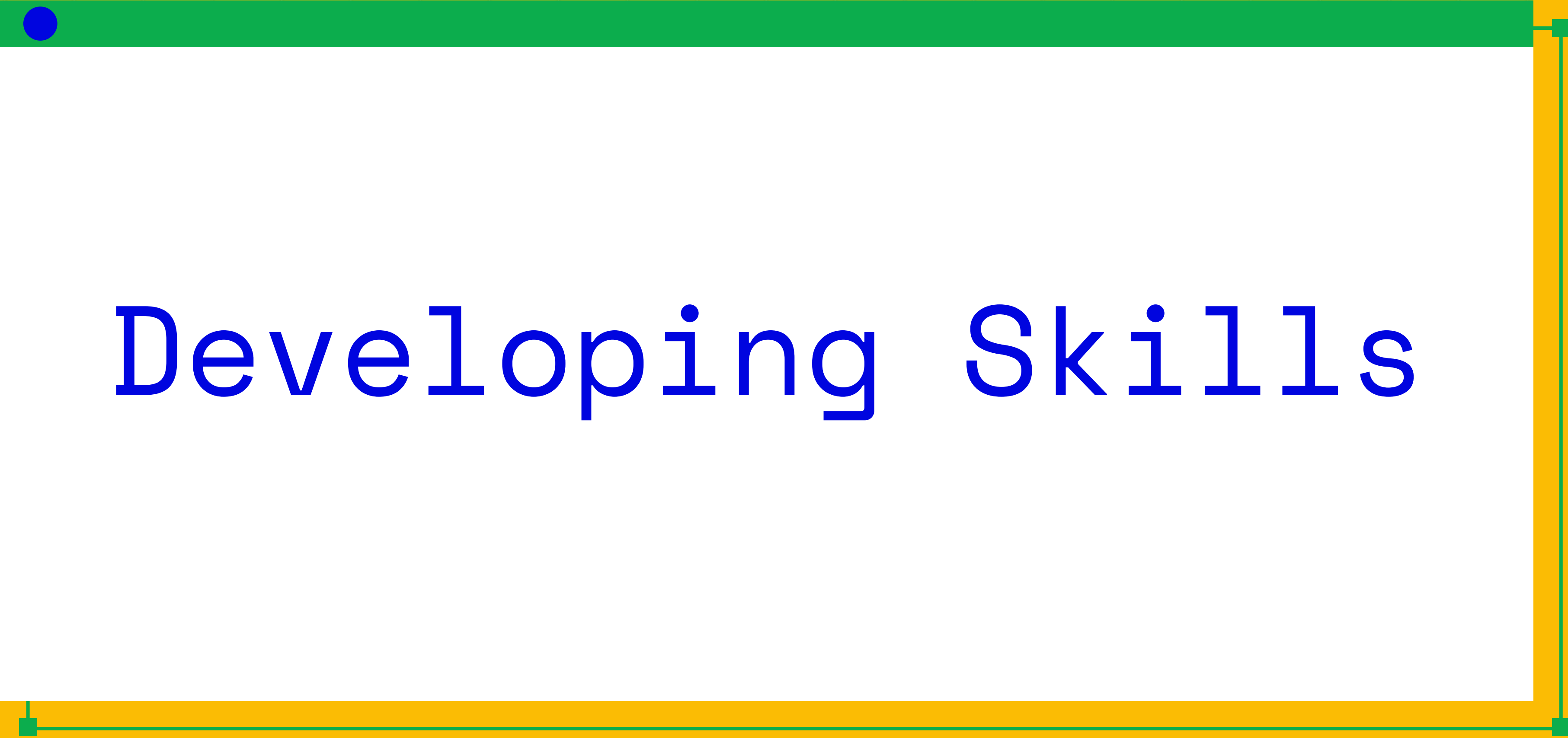


# The Costs of Staying Shy

- **Hidden Potential:** People might assume you are less capable than you actually are because you do not speak up
- **Missed Opportunities:** Your innovative solutions might be ignored during team meetings or hackathons
- **Career Limits:** In the tech industry, moving up to roles like "Team Lead" or "Project Manager" requires presenting progress reports and leading discussions

# The Benefits of Speaking Up

- **Impact:** You can convince others to adopt your software or fund your project
- **Empowerment:** Being able to communicate your logic clearly makes you a much more valuable member of any development team



# Developing Skills



# A Three-Step Process for Improvement

- **Observe:** Watch how others present
  - Do they move around?
  - How do they use their voice to highlight a key point?
- **Study and Reflect:** Look for specific techniques
  - For example, watch a tech talk or a YouTube coding tutorial
  - Identify two things they do well and think about how you can do the same
- **Practice and Get Feedback:** Try the techniques yourself.
  - Record yourself explaining a project on your phone (or present to a friend)
  - Ask: "Was my explanation clear?" Use their notes to improve

# Key Terminology of PowerPoint

- **Deck:** The entire set of slides for your presentation
- **Slide:** A single page, each should have one clear "Slide Title"
- **Gloss:** This is what you say about the slide
  - Never just read the text on the screen
- **Exhibits:** Key graphics
  - such as a screenshot of your app's UI or a code flowchart
  - You must explain these to the audience

# Design Principles

- **Keep it Simple:** Use minimal text
  - Use bullet points instead of long paragraphs
- **Font and Color:** Use professional, clear fonts
  - Make sure there is high contrast (like dark text on a light background)
  - Attendees in the back of the hall can see your work clearly
- **Rule of Thirds:**
  - Balance your images and text so the slide is easy to read



# Design Principles (Example)

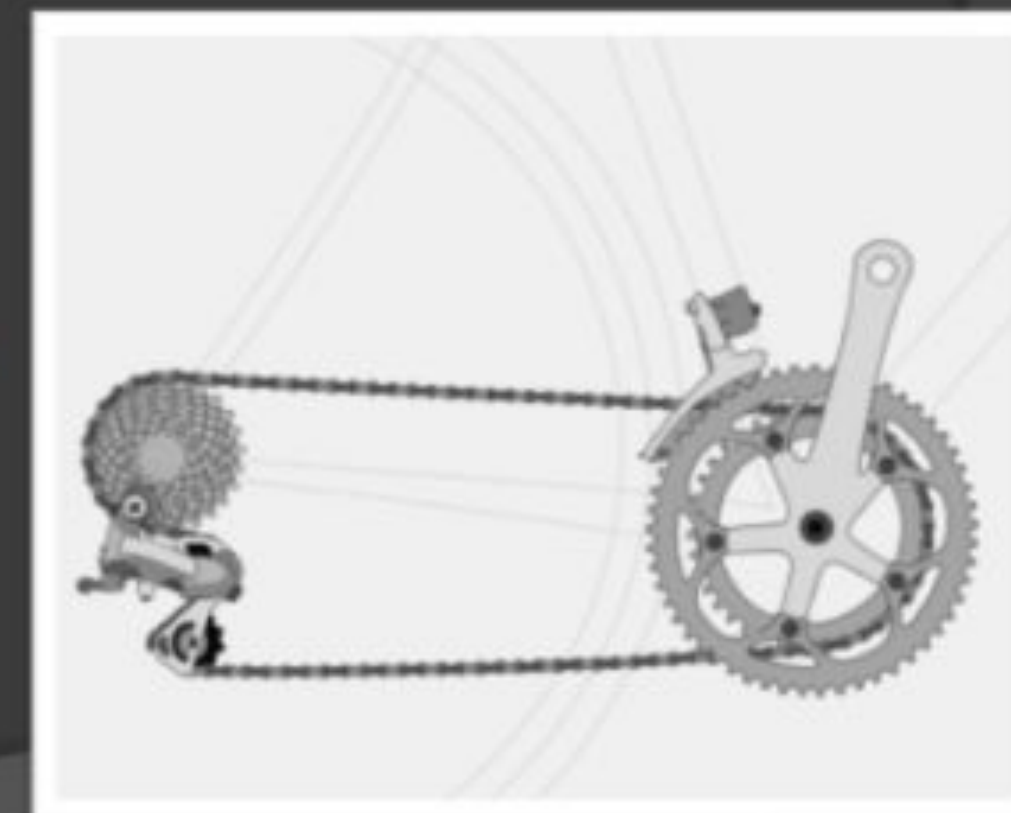
**Slide Title**

**Body Text**

## Diagrams

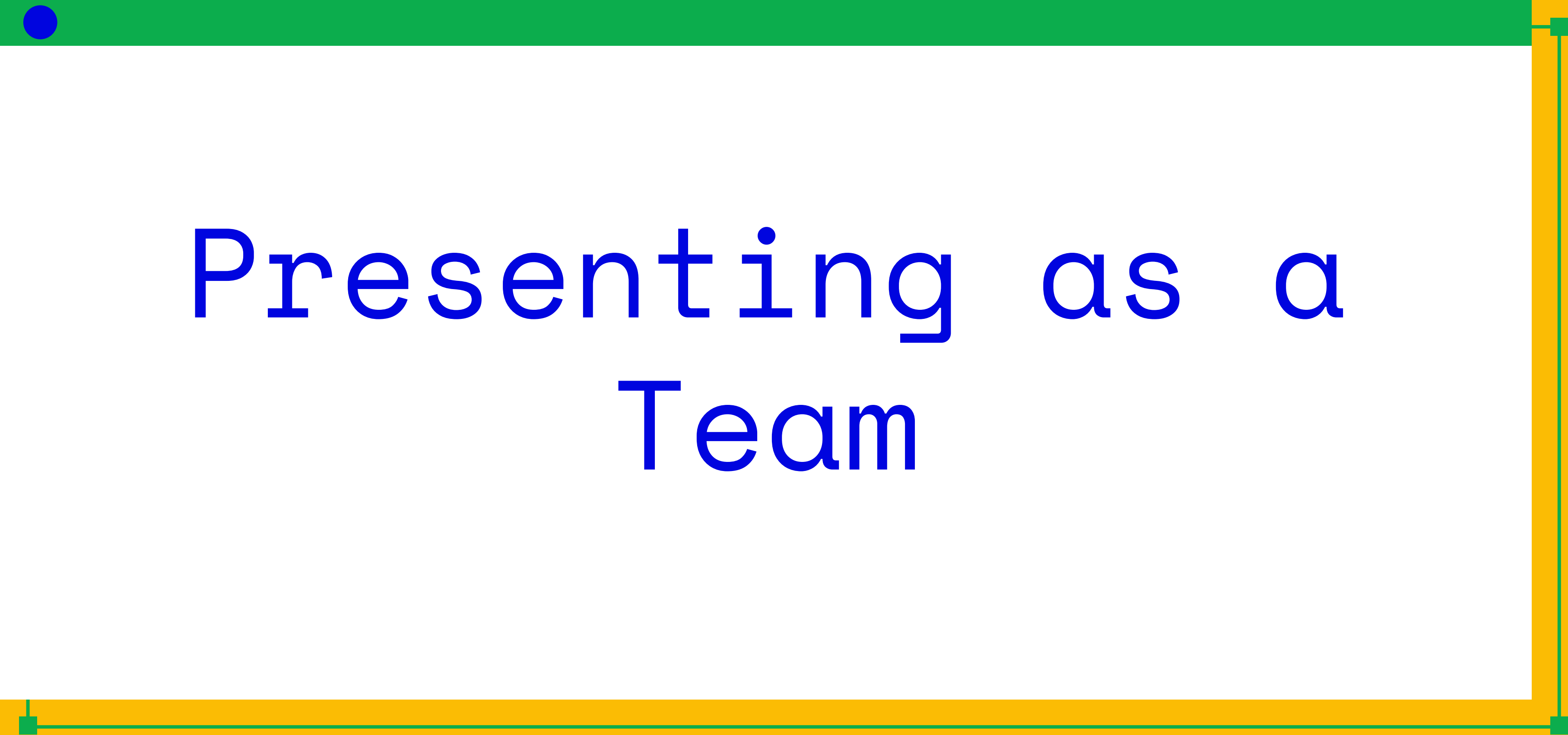
- Simplified, realistic depictions of objects or specific aspects/details
- Portrays what is most relevant and clarifies information; focuses on important features

**Figure 6. Bicycle drivetrain**



**Exhibit with  
caption above and  
source identified  
below**

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Derailleur\\_gears#/media/File:Derailleur\\_Bicycle\\_Drivetrain.svg](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Derailleur_gears#/media/File:Derailleur_Bicycle_Drivetrain.svg)



# Presenting as a Team

# Coordination is Key

Imagine your team is presenting a "Smart Traffic System"

- **Bad Coordination:**

- Student A finishes and just sits down
- Student B stands up and says, "Okay, I will talk about the database now"

- **Good Coordination:**

- Student A finishes by saying, "Now that we've seen the traffic problems, Student B will show you how our database handles the real-time sensor data to solve these issues"



# Shared Responsibility

Even when you are not the one speaking, you are still "on stage."

- **Don't:**

- Look at your phone, whisper to another teammate
- Look bored while someone else speaks

- **Do:**

- Act as a supportive audience,
- which makes the whole team look professional and confident to the professors

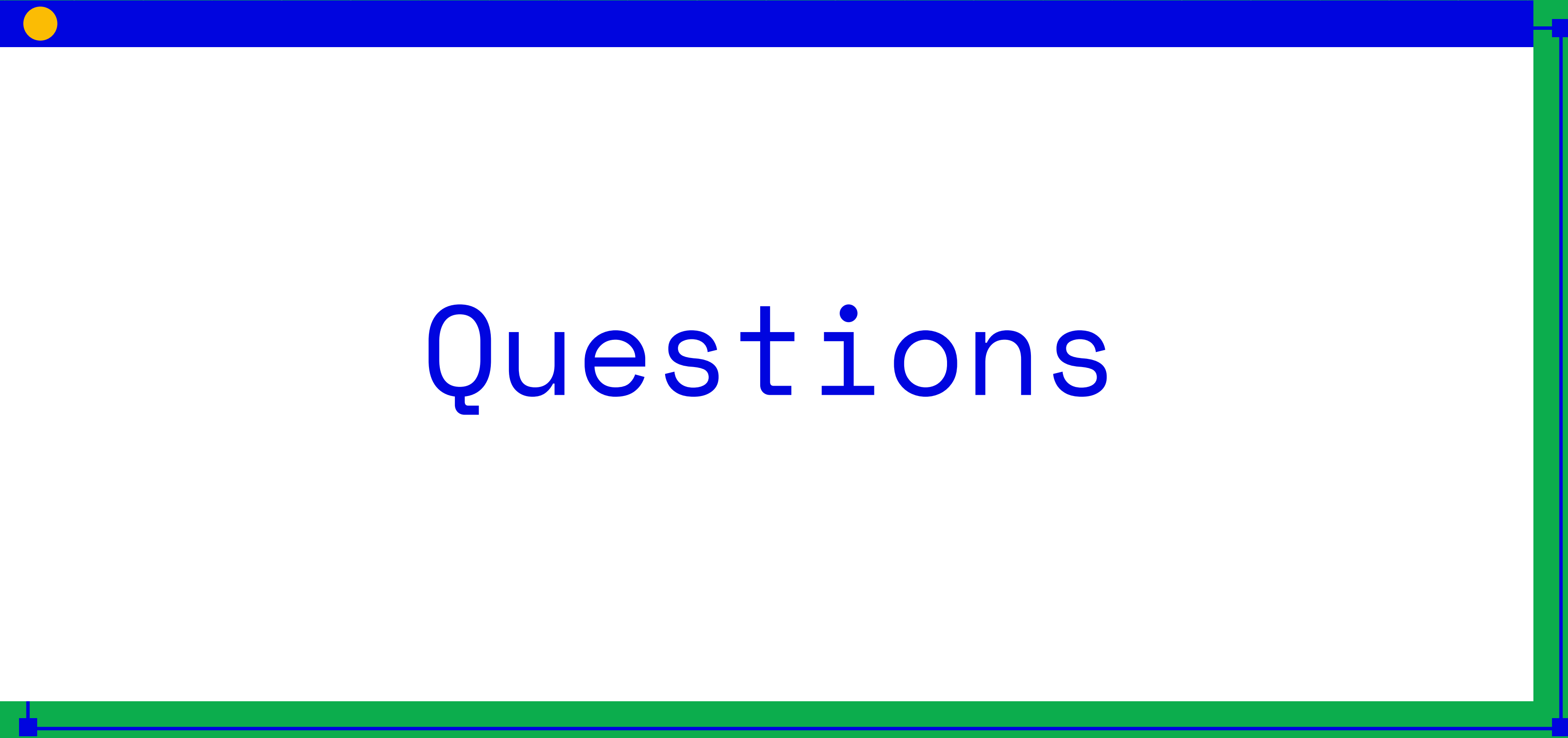
# Preparing Together

- **The "Logic Check":** Ensure the presentation's flow makes sense
  - Does the "Introduction" naturally lead into the "Technical Demo"?
- **The Time Check:**
  - Practice to make sure everyone stays within their time limit
- **Handling Questions:**
  - Decide who will answer which type of question
  - This way helps to prevent the "Who's going to answer?" awkward silence

# Unity in Design

- Use the same font, colors, and icon style throughout
- If Student A uses a dark theme and Student B uses a light theme, the presentation will appear "buggy"
- Always merge your slides early and review the final design as a group.





# Questions